

# Leith Hawkins

SENIOR LAND MANAGEMENT & BIODIVERSITY LEADER

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**Location:** Armidale, NSW

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## PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Highly accomplished, commercially-minded leader with over 20 years of experience in Land Management, Private Land Conservation, and Biodiversity sectors. Proven track record of managing multi-million dollar portfolios, designing state-wide policies, and leading high-performing multidisciplinary teams. Deeply experienced in environmental markets, the NSW Biodiversity Offsets Scheme, and building trusted partnerships with landholders, agricultural producers, and government stakeholders.

## CORE COMPETENCIES

- Strategic Direction & Portfolio Growth
- Biodiversity Offsets & Stewardship Agreements (BSAs)
- Multidisciplinary Team Leadership & Development
- Project Governance, Budgeting & Risk Management
- Landholder Engagement & Relationship Management
- GIS Spatial Architecture & Python Analytics
- Environmental Policy & Carbon Market Integration
- Incident Command & Legal/Compliance Frameworks

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## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### Principal Offsets and Biodiversity Advisor | Inland Rail

JANUARY 2026 — PRESENT

Lead advisor on in-corridor environmental matters and compliance for 35 large-scale offset properties across QLD and NSW. Direct environmental offset portfolios, negotiate stewardship agreements, and manage ecological support contracts.

- Project-manage a \$3.8 million contract for ecological support, tracking deliverables and budgets.
- Lead negotiations with landholders, traditional owner groups (cultural heritage), and federal/state agencies (including DCCEEW) to secure stewardship agreements under the EPBC Act.
- Designed and executed landscape-scale Sentinel-2 satellite vegetation monitoring and spectral analysis to map invasive weed infestations, implementing targeted, high-efficiency management programs.

### Regional Manager | NSW Biodiversity Conservation Trust (BCT), Armidale

JANUARY 2021 — JANUARY 2026

Directed strategic operations for the Northern Inland Region. Managed regional Private Land Conservation portfolios and led on-ground ecological teams to deliver the Biodiversity Offsets Scheme.

- Led delivery of major biodiversity offsets, securing over 45,000 hectares of high-conservation-value land.
- Directly led the regional Environmental Monitoring Module to verify biodiversity gains across BSAs.
- Collaborated with BCT legal counsel to draft and execute complex agreements under strict regulatory frameworks.
- Advised landholders on co-existence and stacking of carbon projects and biodiversity offset agreements.
- Spearheaded the Liverpool Plains Tender, aligning prime agricultural land with stacked market outcomes.

### Program Manager (Supporting Our Neighbours) | Local Land Services (LLS), Armidale

APRIL 2020 — JANUARY 2021

Foundational staff member responsible for designing and executing the operational policies, procedures, and governance for a state-wide \$209 Million bushfire recovery and agricultural grant program.

- Directed daily operations for up to 65 personnel across 11 LLS regions to deliver high-volume grants.
- Managed procurement of help desk solutions and delivered daily indicator reports for the Minister and executive.
- Created and maintained comprehensive risk management registers and financial reporting systems for Treasury.

### Team Leader – Environment | Northern Tablelands Local Land Services, Armidale

FEBRUARY 2018 — MARCH 2020

Directed the design, budget allocation, and implementation of environmental programs with a \$2.5 Million annual budget. Chaired the Rehabilitation subcommittee of the National Regent Honeyeater recovery committee, bridging science and management.

**Senior Land Services Officer – Biosecurity | Northern Tablelands LLS, Armidale**

MARCH 2016 — FEBRUARY 2018

Designed operational biosecurity compliance tools and developed custom Python/GIS spatial models to resolve risk and vertebrate pest challenges.

**Senior Land Services Officer – GIS | Northern Tablelands LLS, Armidale**

JANUARY 2014 — FEBRUARY 2016

Developed state-wide GIS architecture and managed the strategic cloud migration framework for LLS spatial datasets.

**Earlier Career History**

**Senior Land Services Officer** | Namoi Catchment Management Authority, Gunnedah (2005 — 2013) — Delivered landholder engagement and business analysis.

**Project Manager** | Greening Australia Queensland, Collinsville (2003 — 2005) — Managed an 8-partner sustainable grazing project in the Burdekin Basin.

**EDUCATION, CREDENTIALS & EMERGENCY COMMAND**

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**Education & Certifications:**

- **Cert IV Project Management**  
UNE Partnerships, Armidale (2014) - PMBOK
- **Diploma Conservation & Land Mgt**  
TAFE, Townsville (2005) - Biodiversity/Agri
- **Cert IV Government Investigations**  
(2018) - NSW Biosecurity Act 2015

**Incident Command & Volunteering:**

- **National Biosecurity Response Team**  
Incident Controller (2021 — 2024)
- **Rural Fire Service Volunteer**  
RFS Upper Horton Brigade (2021 — 2024)
- **Key Certs:** PUAOPE018 (L2 Control) | PUAOPE025 (L2 Planning) | UAV Pilot

**REFERENCES**

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Professional references are available immediately upon request.